

Be(a)ware of the Smart Home

Smart homes are great. They are more energy-efficient, safe and comfortable too. But, you need to resist the temptation to micro-manage your home, or it can make you dizzy! Let us set you thinking by telling you a few (mostly nice) things about the emerging smart home



Nest Protect and Thermostat lifestyle

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A home that runs like clockwork

A smart home could satiate unfulfilled dreams—kids who switch off the fans when they leave the room, a husband who helps around the kitchen or a wife who wakes you up with a hot cup of coffee!

A smart home can pamper you and see to your every comfort. Your water heater will turn on when you enter the home, the coffee maker will start brewing when you park your car, the air-conditioner will turn up the temperature when you pull up your blanket tighter. It is just what you need to live a comfortable life, 24x7.

One look at the current generation

of consumer electronics and smart home platforms is enough to prove this point.

Whether it is a washing machine to which you can send your instructions (LG), a learning thermostat (Nest), intelligent remote-controlled lights that can wake you up with gradual lighting (Philips), a super-smart mobile-controlled security system (Piper), easy to setup motion sensors and baby monitors (WeMo) which help watch your home or a TV that switches itself off when you fall asleep (Sony), today's chip-equipped gadgets ensure that your home runs like clockwork.

There are some brilliant examples in this space, and one

such device that is expected to create waves is Rotimatic.

Dubbed as a one-touch solution for fresh chapatis, Rotimatic is a device developed recently by an Indian couple for making chapatis, apparently inspired by the long hours Indian wives spend in the kitchen.

You can customise everything from the number of chapatis and the amount of oil in each chapati, to their thickness and crispness. Each chapati takes around a minute to prepare and slides out temptingly from the cute machine! Launched in Singapore, Rotimatic is expected to be sold in the Indian market too, perhaps sometime this year.

The Internet-connected crock-pot launched by Belkin at CES 2014 is another example to show how automation is invading the kitchen. The WeMo-compatible slow-cooker can be programmed and controlled remotely too. So, you can load it with all that needs to be cooked for dinner and switch it on just before you leave office.

The watchdog that never sleeps

"With the increase in nuclear families and urban living with double-income



The Internet-connected crock-pot (WeMo-compatible slow-cooker) launched by Belkin